HOLLIS CENTER FOR ENVIRONMENTAL JOURNALISM
122 E. Gilman St., Madison, WI 53703 · (608) 555-0109 · hollisjournalism.org/fellowship

2027 Hollis Fellowship in Environmental Reporting

Application form

FELLOWSHIP TERM	STIPEND	APPLICATION DEADLINE
February 1 to July 31, 2027 Half-time	$42,000 Plus an agreed reporting budget	Tuesday, September 15, 2026 11:59 p.m. CT

Complete every section. Upload this form with your project proposal (no more than 1,500 words) and three published clips at hollisjournalism.org/fellowship. Enter your two references in the portal; each will receive a link to a one-page reference form.

1. APPLICANT

NAME
Owen Brandt

PHONE
(612) 555-0183

ADDRESS
4127 34th Ave S, Minneapolis, MN 55406

EMAIL
owen.brandt.writes@gmail.com

CURRENT WORK
Freelance science and environment journalist, July 2019 to present. Regular contributor to North Current, Great Lakes Dispatch, Prairie Wire and Field & Flow.

PREVIOUS WORK
Reporter, Twin Cities Ledger, 1999 to 2019

YEARS AS A WORKING JOURNALIST
27

STAFF OR FREELANCE
Freelance

HOW DID YOU HEAR ABOUT THE FELLOWSHIP?
Hollis Center Notes newsletter, August 2026

2. PROJECT

Summarize the project here. Upload the full proposal separately.

PROJECT TITLE
Salt Lines: Chloride in Upper Midwest Lakes

FORMAT
Four-part reported series with a public data appendix

TERM
February to July 2027, half-time

WHERE THE REPORTING WILL TAKE PLACE
Twin Cities metro, Duluth, Madison and northern Wisconsin

SUMMARY (150 WORDS OR FEWER)
Road salt keeps winter roads open and leaves chloride behind in lakes, streams and groundwater, where it does not break down. Watershed districts across the region now spend real money measuring it and trying to slow it. Salt Lines will follow the chloride from the plow route to the lake to the aquifer, read the monitoring data closely, check selected numbers with independent samples, and ask who pays. The series builds on a feature I am reporting this fall on road salt and Twin Cities lakes.

PUBLICATION PLAN
I will offer the series to the regional nonprofit and magazine outlets I write for regularly. The data appendix will be free to republish.

3. CLIPS

List three published clips and upload each one as a PDF.

	HEADLINE	OUTLET	PUBLISHED	EDITOR
a	Ice-out on the Big Lake	Great Lakes Dispatch	May 2026	Marcus Webb
b	Who pays for beach closures	Great Lakes Dispatch	July 2026	Marcus Webb
c	Brine before the storm	Twin Cities Ledger	January 2018	Ruth Engel

4. REFERENCES

Name two people who have edited or supervised your work. Enter their email addresses in the portal; the Center contacts them directly.

	NAME	TITLE AND ORGANIZATION	RELATIONSHIP TO APPLICANT
a	Marcus Webb	Editor, Great Lakes Dispatch, Chicago	Edited clips a and b
b	Ruth Engel	Former metro editor, Twin Cities Ledger	My metro editor at the Ledger; edited clip c

☒ Contact details for both references were entered in the online portal.

5. REPORTING BUDGET REQUEST (SEPARATE FROM STIPEND)

Itemize the reporting costs you expect during the term. The $42,000 stipend is paid separately and is not part of this request.

ITEM	DETAIL	AMOUNT (USD)
Laboratory analysis	Chloride, about 40 field samples, commercial laboratory	$3,600
Travel	Duluth, Madison and northern Wisconsin: mileage, lodging and meals	$2,900
Records and data	Public-records requests and data fees	$300
Total reporting budget requested		**$6,800**

6. AVAILABILITY AND RELATED WORK

CAN YOU WORK ON THE PROJECT HALF-TIME FROM FEBRUARY 1 TO JULY 31, 2027?

Yes

OTHER PROFESSIONAL COMMITMENTS DURING THE TERM

Monthly fact-check column for North Current; occasional freelance assignments.

IS ANY PART OF THIS PROJECT UNDER ASSIGNMENT OR CONTRACT WITH ANOTHER OUTLET? IF YES, EXPLAIN.

Yes. North Current magazine approved my feature on road salt and Twin Cities lakes on September 10. It runs about 3,000 words and will be filed in November, before the fellowship term begins. The fellowship series would carry that reporting across the region.

7. CERTIFICATION

I certify that the information in this application is accurate and that the proposed work is my own.

SIGNATURE (TYPE FULL NAME)

Owen Brandt

DATE

September 14, 2026